

RECIPROCITY APPLICATION FOR CERTIFIED COURT INTERPRETERS

Court interpreter certification through reciprocity is described in Superintendence Rule 9.01 of the Rules of Superintendence for the Courts of Ohio. **Candidates who wish to apply to receive reciprocity must mail all information required below.**

Additionally, in accordance with Superintendence Rule 9.07 a Supreme Court Certified Interpreter must complete and report at least 24 credit hours of continuing education offered or accredited by the Language Services Section for each two-year reporting period, including eighteen credit hours of general hours and six credit hours of ethics training.

Please complete the entire application. Do not leave any fields blank. INCOMPLETE APPLICATIONS WILL BE RETURNED.

Application Information:

☐ Mr./☐ Mrs./☐ Ms./☐ Dr.: _____
(select preferred) Last Name First Name Middle Name

Mailing Address: _____
Street Address City State Zip

Home Phone: _____ Cell Phone: _____

Email: _____ Driver's License #: _____ State: _____

Language(s) of Expertise: _____

Court Certification Information:

Please indicate the credentials that you have obtained and provide exam testing location, date the credential was received, and whether or not your credential remains current.

Certifying Body:	Date of Certification	Language	Expiration (if any)	Written Score	Oral Scores
State Court Certification (List State)	Date: State:				
Federal Certification					
Other Accredited Entity					

Background Information:

Have you ever taken a court interpreter Examination in another state? If yes, State: _____, Year: _____	Yes ☐ No ☐
Have you ever been certified or licensed as an interpreter in another state? If yes, where? _____	Yes ☐ No ☐
Have you ever been convicted of a felony? If yes, explain: _____ _____	Yes ☐ No ☐
Have you ever been convicted of a misdemeanor other than a traffic violation? If yes, explain: _____ _____	Yes ☐ No ☐
Do you have a legal right to live and work in the United States?	Yes ☐ No ☐

Certification

I certify that the answers I provided to the questions in this application are true and complete to the best of my knowledge. I understand that if this application is not completed in its entirety, it may not be processed and it will be returned to me at the address on the form. I also understand that a background check will be ordered prior to receiving reciprocity from the Supreme Court of Ohio.

Applicant Signature	Date
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**Supreme Court of Ohio
Language Services Section
Court Interpreter Reciprocity Checklist**

In order to be considered for reciprocity in Ohio, you must meet basic eligibility, reciprocity specific conditions, submit written exam results, 24-hours of court interpreter training, an oral proficiency assessment or interview.

**CERTIFIED AND REGISTERED INTERPRETERS
Ohio Rules of Superintendence 9.01 and 9.02**

1. Basic Eligibility (provide a copy of passport or driver's license)

- ☐ At least 18 years old
- ☐ U.S. citizen, legal resident, or authorized to work in the U.S.
- ☐ Oath (Language Services Section will email once application is received)
- ☐ Background check (run by Language Services Section)

2. Reciprocity-Specific Condition

- ☐ Certified Interpreters (Sup. R. 9.01(I))
 - ☐ Federal courts: provide proof of certification and be in good standing with the certifying body.
 - ☐ Another state: provide proof of having passed the oral examination. The Section may verify the test score information and testing history before approving certification.
 - ☐ NCSC: provide proof of having received a substantially comparable score. The Section may verify the test score information and testing history before approving reciprocal certification.
 - ☐ All other certifying bodies: reviewed case-by-case considering testing criteria, reliability, and validity. The Section shall verify the test score after accepting the certifying body's criteria.
- ☐ Registered Interpreters (Sup. R. 9.02): Must be ineligible for full certification in Ohio because the language does NOT have an available NCSC oral examination.

3. Written Examination Requirement

- ☐ Submit National Center for State Courts (NCSC) written exam score
- ☐ Minimum 80% score in English language & grammar, Court-related terminology, Professional conduct
- ☐ Submit Orientation Training dates

4. Oral Examination Requirement

- ☐ Submit National Center for State Courts (NCSC) Oral exam scores
- ☐ Minimum 70% score in English language & grammar, Court-related terminology, Professional conduct

5. Required Training (24 Hours Total)

- ☐ 6 hours – Legal terminology
- ☐ 6 hours – Interpreter ethics
- ☐ 12 hours – Modes of interpretation / advanced training

6. Language Proficiency Requirement

- ☐ Complete an oral proficiency assessment
- ☐ Achieve 'superior/native-level fluency' (top of scale)

7. Application & Documentation

- ☐ Submit formal application to the Supreme Court of Ohio
- ☐ Provide proof of identity/age
- ☐ Provide proof of legal work status
- ☐ Pay applicable application fee

8. Placement & Status

- ☐ If approved → placed on the statewide roster of interpreters
- ☐ Eligible to receive court assignments across Ohio

9. Ongoing Requirement (Post-Approval)

- ☐ Complete 24 hours of continuing education every 2 years
- ☐ Including 6 hours of ethics

10. Payment Information

A \$25.00 non-refundable fee is assessed to apply for certification reciprocity.

Make payments to the Supreme Court of Ohio. Applications without payment will not be accepted.

Mail to the following address:

Supreme Court of Ohio:
Language Services Section
65 S. Front Street, 6th Floor
Columbus, OH 43215-3431